All non-excludable goods are not depleted by excessive usage. As an example, consider a large number of people tuning in to a radio channel. The number of people tuning in does not diminish the radio signal available. This discussion is limited to common pool resources which are depleted by excessive usage.

We could combat this market failure in three ways: state control, privatization, or a Coasean solution involving private contracts. Each of these solutions has problems:

- State control requires setting up a complex bureaucracy that will monitor, allocate and enforce. In many situations, the magnitude of the resources being allocated (e.g., pastureland associated with a village) does not justify the expenditure on the state solution.
- Privatization is infeasible in some problems (e.g., the open sea). Cutting pastureland into small plots can yield an inferior solution as the grass may grow in different places at different times of the year.
- A Coasean solution does not easily come about, as it is difficult to get a large number of people (e.g., all fishermen) to come together and negotiate.

The political scientist Elinor Ostrom discovered that many practical institutional arrangements, established by traditional communities over very long periods of time, achieve good results. Some of the examples that she has studied have been practised for hundreds of years or even for a thousand years. Her examples include communal tenure of high mountain meadows and forests in Switzerland and Japan, the *huerta* irrigation systems in Spain and the *zanjera* irrigation system in the Philippines.

Much research is required in India, on traditional arrangements that have been brushed aside in the first flush of modernization, to look more deeply about how well they perform. For instance, the moratorium on eating fish during the month of Shravan is commonly understood to tie in with the spawning season. But we have not studied the roots of such arrangements from the lens of solving common goods problems. [4]